Maren

SHARED WITH THE MEZO ECOSYSTEM TEAM

Go-to-Market

How Maren reaches the people it was built for

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Maren Finance • Bitcoin liquidity, gasless spending, and yield • Built on Mezo Chain

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Summary

Maren's go-to-market rests on a single honest observation about Mezo:

> ***MUSD is a farming instrument, not consumer money.*** *Of ~31M supply, only ~4.6% was created by user borrowing; ~46% sits in the Stability Pool, and the top 20 addresses, almost all contracts, hold ~99.5%.*

There is no consumer economy for MUSD. Two things stand in the way. The protocol imposes a **2,000 MUSD minimum loan**, about $3,000 of BTC to open responsibly, so a small holder cannot borrow at all; and once you hold MUSD there is nowhere consumer-grade to spend it.

That sets the launch honestly. We are not capturing a proven demand; we are betting that a consumer layer, led by a pooled vault with **no minimum loan size** and payments that work, creates borrowing the protocol cannot reach on its own. The evidence for that bet is off-chain, in Mezo's community, not yet on-chain in the trove count.

This document covers who we go to, in what order, and what we would ask of Mezo, with an explicit note on which channels we think are overrated.

1. Who Maren is for

Three audiences, in the order we pursue them.

A. Small borrowers the minimum shuts out

The primary audience, and the one Judy pointed us to. These are Bitcoin holders who want to borrow small, less than the 2,000 MUSD the protocol will open, and who today either cannot or are pushed to the liquidation edge. The pooled vault is the only venue on Mezo that lets them borrow $25 against $77 of BTC safely.

We are deliberately not claiming the ~29,000 MUSD holders are a proven pipeline of these borrowers. That number is a long tail of dust and it proves nothing about demand; treating it as a queue of waiting customers is the vanity metric a Mezo insider sees through instantly. Whether enough people want to borrow small against Bitcoin to spend is the bet Maren is making, and the honest place it rests is Mezo's off-chain community, not its holder count.

The message is not aspirational. It is: *borrow against your own Bitcoin from 0.001 BTC, with no minimum loan size, and spend it.*

They are reachable, because Mezo's Discord is where they already are.

B. Small Bitcoin holders outside Mezo

Holders of 0.01—0.1 BTC, too small for a direct trove, exactly the size Maren's pooled vault is built for. Motivated by tax (selling is a taxable event in most jurisdictions) and by conviction (they do not want to sell).

Higher acquisition cost, larger pool. This is the growth audience, not the launch audience.

C. People who want to spend, not to farm

MUSD holders with no consumer-grade way to use it. `@handle` payments, requests, splits, and payment links, all gasless. This is where retention comes from: borrowing is an event, spending is a habit.

We are explicitly not chasing yield tourists. MUSD's Stability Pool has no token emissions and its returns are lumpy liquidation gains. We will not advertise an APY we cannot sustain, and capital that arrives for a number leaves for a bigger one.

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2. Sequence

Phase 0: Matsnet, weeks 4—5 (Sept)

Public testnet, opened to the Mezo Discord.

The goal is not signups. It is to find what breaks with real users, particularly around oracle staleness reverts and keeper behaviour under simulated drawdowns, failure modes that tests do not surface because tests do not behave like people.

Success: 50 testnet users, every core flow exercised, a written list of what broke.

Phase 1: Mainnet launch, week 8 (10 Oct)

Vault capped at 5 BTC. Direct troves uncapped.

- Launch post: how DeFi-internal MUSD actually is, roughly 4.6% of supply borrowed by users, stated with numbers measured that morning, and the pooled vault as the fix.
- Technical writeup of the seven ways MUSD diverges from Liquity and the three doc/bytecode discrepancies, offered as a contribution to other Mezo builders, not as criticism. **This is the piece most likely to travel**, because it is genuinely useful and nobody else has written it.
- Co-marketing with Mezo (Discord, @MezoNetwork, @SupernormalFDN).

Success: 50 funded positions, $50k borrowed, zero incidents.

Phase 2: Audit and open the cap, weeks 9—14

Publish the audit in full, including findings. Raise the cap to 25 BTC. Apply for Mezo Market listing.

Success: audit published, cap raised, listed.

Phase 3: Payments as the habit, weeks 15—22

Shift the story from borrowing to spending. Handle registration drive; merchant pilot with 3—5 Mezo ecosystem projects accepting MUSD through `MarenPay`.

Success: 250 funded positions, $250k borrowed, 1,000 payments (the M3 milestone).

Phase 4: iOS, weeks 23—28

App Store launch. Mobile is where a payments product becomes a habit or does not.

Success: live on the App Store, sustained 30 days.

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3. Channels

Ranked by expected return, with the ones we are sceptical of named as such.

1. Mezo's own channels. 180k-member Discord, @MezoNetwork, @SupernormalFDN. The highest-intent audience that exists for this product, and the offer on the table. We would rather use it **twice, well**: at mainnet launch and at iOS launch, than continuously and thinly.

2. Technical writing. The MUSD integration findings, the pooled-vault design, the gasless architecture on a chain where ERC-4337 is a dead end. This builds the developer credibility that precedes a serious user base, and it is the channel where the work already done is the content.

3. Ecosystem partnerships. Merchant acceptance with other Mezo projects. Mutually useful, low cost, and it makes MUSD circulate rather than sit.

4. Bitcoin-native communities. Nostr, Bitcoin Twitter, r/Bitcoin. High conviction, high scepticism, and rightly hostile to anything that smells like a token. Maren's lack of a token is an asset here, but this audience punishes overreach, so we enter with the technical writing, not with marketing.

Explicitly deprioritised: paid acquisition (wrong stage, wrong trust dynamics), influencer campaigns (actively counterproductive with a Bitcoin audience), airdrop farming (attracts precisely the users we do not want), and a token (we are not launching one, see below).

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4. What we ask of Mezo

Ranked by value to us, which is not the same as cost to them.

1. **An introduction to the MUSD auditors.** Worth more than the grant money. See the Roadmap paper.
2. **Fifty testnet users from the Discord in September.** Cheap for Mezo, disproportionately valuable to us.
3. **A technical contact for MUSD questions**, particularly the three doc/bytecode discrepancies.
4. **Co-marketing at the two launches**, M1 and M4, not continuously.
5. **Mezo Market listing** once the audit is complete.
6. **Introductions to 3—5 ecosystem projects** for the merchant pilot.

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5. Positioning

Maren, Spend Bitcoin. Never sell it.

What we say:

- Bitcoin-backed credit from **0.001 BTC**, with **no minimum loan size**, where the protocol imposes a 2,000 MUSD minimum loan.
- **No gas.** You never need to hold BTC to move your money.
- Payments that work like messaging: `@handle`, requests, splits, links.
- **No token.** Revenue comes from spread on real usage.

What we deliberately do not say:

- No fixed APY on Earn. The yield is lumpy liquidation gains and we show trailing realised returns, labelled as backward-looking.
- No “100% Bitcoin-backed” claim about MUSD generally, true of the CDP portion, not of most circulating supply.
- No “your funds are safe” about the pooled vault. It is a mechanism, and mechanisms fail.
- No “audited” until it is.

Voice: calm, precise, adult. We are handling people’s Bitcoin. The competition for attention in crypto is won by volume; the competition for custody is won by restraint.

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6. On not launching a token

Maren will not have a token. Stated here because it is a go-to-market decision, not just a financial one.

A token would be the fastest way to acquire users and the fastest way to acquire the wrong ones. For a Bitcoin-native audience, “we are not printing a token” is a positive signal, and the predecessor product held the same line.

Revenue instead comes from spread on real usage: a margin over the protocol’s 1% borrow rate on pooled positions, a fee on payment volume above the free tier, and a performance fee on Earn. At **$0.0092 per 100,000 gas** (1,462,500 wei at a $62,922 BTC price), the gas Maren sponsors is a rounding error against any of these, sponsorship is a customer-acquisition cost measured in cents.

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7. Honest measures

Metrics chosen because they are hard to game, not because they flatter.

METRIC	WHY IT IS HONEST
Funded positions	Requires real collateral; cannot be farmed
MUSD borrowed through Maren	On-chain, verifiable by Mezo
Payments settled	Usage, not deposits
30-day retention of borrowers	The number that decides whether this is a product
Median position size	Confirms we are reaching small holders, not just large ones

Deliberately excluded: TVL (measures deposits, not use), waitlist size, social followers, and testnet transactions.

The single number we hold ourselves to: **250 funded positions**, a tenfold increase in borrowing accounts on Mezo. We would rather commit to a figure we might miss than to one we would certainly hit.

8. What we already bring

Not projections. Things that exist today.

- **A shipped predecessor.** Talise, on Sui: 1,900+ waitlist signups, 1,400+ handles claimed on-chain, live mainnet contracts, and a published security audit.
- **Upstream contributions prepared**, and offered regardless of the grant outcome: a fix for viem's Mezo chain definition (its default RPC does not resolve and the mainnet entry omits Multicall3, silently breaking batched reads for every wagmi user), a correction to the subgraph documentation's network slug (a manifest copied from the docs fails to deploy), and several dead RPC hosts in the developer docs.
- **A verified integration map for MUSD**: the seven Liquity divergences and the three doc/bytecode discrepancies, which is the document we wish had existed when we started, and which we intend to publish for the next builder.